



Racket Sports Pregame Neural Warm-Up

6–8 minutes

"Stretching gets you loose. Neural warm-ups get you sharp" — Dr. Shah

1

Monocular Eye Stretches

30–45 sec

Why: Isolates each eye, reduces dominance issues, improves wall reads and accuracy

How

- Cover one eye
- Use the open eye to trace an **"English flag" pattern**:
 - Up left → up right
 - Middle left → middle right
 - Down left → down right
- Hit **all corners once**
- Switch eyes and repeat

Coaching cue

"Smooth control, no rushing."

*This exposes weak eye control **before** it shows up in play.*

2

Horizontal + Vertical Saccades

45–60 sec

Why: Fast wall-to-ball reads, deception detection

How

- Two fingers at eye level
- Horizontal: left ↔ right (20–30 reps)
- Vertical: up ↑ down (20–30 reps)
- Head still, jaw relaxed

Coaching cue

"Eyes move clean, face stays quiet."

■ If jaw or head moves → motor overflow → nervous system already leaking energy.

3

VOR + Cossack Squats

60 sec

Why: Head movement + balance + visual stability under load (huge for lunging)

How

- Thumb at arm's length
- Lock eyes on thumb
- Rotate head side-to-side
- Perform slow Cossack squats (5–6 each side)

Coaching cue

"Eyes stay locked, body moves underneath."

This mimics lunging while tracking the ball.

4

Thumb Push-Ups

45 sec | x5 thumbs if shared warm-up

Why: Depth perception + front-court control

How

- Thumb at arm's length
- Slowly bring toward nose until it doubles
- Push back out until single again
- 8–10 controlled reps

Coaching cue

"Clear → double → clear. No rushing."

*This primes **short-range convergence**, which squash demands constantly.*

5

Wall Juggling

90 sec

Why: Peripheral awareness + anticipation

How

- Stand 4–6 feet from wall
- Juggle or toss one ball against wall, then increase to progression below
- Eyes stay **forward**, not chasing the ball
- Progression: alternate hands + add a second ball, third ball...

Coaching cue

"See it without staring at it."

*This is **pure squash vision**.*

6

Quiet-Eye Reset ■ HIGH VALUE

30–45 sec

Why: Reduces pre-match chaos, improves decision-making

How

- Pick a small spot on the front wall
- Soft focus, nasal breathing
- 4 sec inhale / 6–8 sec exhale × 5 breaths

Coaching cue

"Calm eyes, calm brain. Elite performance."